SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

23 October 2024 · Shift 3

74 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 16 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 11 questions

Q.3

In an experiment to determine the refractive index of water, a student took five sets of observations and got the values for the refractive index of water as 1.32, 1.37, 1.36, 1.39 and 1.31. What is its average value?

(A) 1.33
(B) 1.34
(C) 1.36
(D) 1.35

Q.4

In an NCC camp, the average weight was 72 kg. If 5 cadets having average weight 76 kg leave and 11 cadets of average weight 79 kg join the group, the average weight of the cadets in the group increases by 0.6 kg. The number of cadets, initially in the group was:

(A) 91
(B) 85
(C) 89
(D) 81

Q.6

By selling an item for ₹ 125, S earns 12% profit. What is the cost of the item (in ₹)? (Correct up to 2 decimal digits)

(A) 116.61
(B) 111.61
(C) 116.16
(D) 111.16

Q.7

After how many years will a sum of ₹8,925 at simple interest fetch a total amount of ₹12,941.25 at the rate of 9% per annum?

(A) 5 years
(B) 4 years
(C) 3 years
(D) 6 years

Q.8

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3000 as a sum borrowed at 8% per year rate of interest for 3 years.

(A) 720
(B) 760
(C) 660
(D) 680

Q.9

The least number of five digits which is exactly divisible by each one of the numbers 12, 15 and 18 is:

(A) 10020
(B) 10080
(C) 10010
(D) 10015

Q.12

Find the average of the numbers 1, –1, 0 and 2.

(A) 4
(B) 2
(C) 0.5
(D) 1.5

Q.13

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2000 as a sum borrowed at 9% per year rate of interest for 3 years.

(A) 480
(B) 580
(C) 540
(D) 500

Q.15

The price of a book is first increased by 10% and then again by 20%. If the price of the book after both increments is ₹33, then the original price (in ₹) of the book is:

(A) 30
(B) 32
(C) 33
(D) 25

Q.18

The average score in the Mathematics exam of a class of 60 students is 52. A group of 8 boys with an average score of 40 left the class and another group of 10 boys with an average score of 43 joined the class. What is the new average score of the class? (correct to one decimal place)

(A) 50.5
(B) 53.9
(C) 55.7
(D) 52.1

Q.20

If the speed of a boat going downstream is 40 km/h and its speed going upstream is 20 km/h, then find the speed of the stream (in km/h).

(A) 15
(B) 10
(C) 40
(D) 20

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

IRIG is related to OXOM in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, DLEC is related to JRKI. To which of the following is SBUS related, following the same logic?

(A) YHYA
(B) YHAY
(C) AYYH
(D) AYHY

Q.3

In a certain code language, 'FIRE' is coded as '9571' and 'ROAD' is coded as '2146'. What is the code for 'R' in the given code language?

(A) 2
(B) 1
(C) 7
(D) 6

Q.5

In a certain code language, ‘pass the ball’ is coded as ‘bq tr vl’ and ‘ball is red’ is coded as ‘hx vo bq’. How is ‘ball’ coded in the given language?

(A) bq
(B) tr
(C) vl
(D) hx

Q.6

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 16 ÷ 4 + 18 – 14 × 7 = ?

(A) 62
(B) 52
(C) 48
(D) 65

Q.7

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (17, 10, 95) (2, 11, 21)

(A) (20, 16, 26)
(B) (24, 18, 128)
(C) (19, 18, 30)
(D) (10, 6, 56)

Q.8

Seven friends, A, B, C, D, E, F and G, are sitting around a table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). B is to the immediate right of F, and A is to the immediate right of B. E is an immediate neighbour of both F and D, while G is an immediate neighbour of both D and C. Who is sitting to the immediate right of A?

(A) C
(B) E
(C) D
(D) B

Q.9

EMHD is related to GOJF in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, IQLH is related to KSNJ. To which of the following is LTOK related following the same logic?

(A) NVQM
(B) NVMQ
(C) VNQM
(D) VNMQ

Q.11

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All vases are portraits. Some portraits are flowers. Conclusions: (I) All flowers are vases. (II) Some flowers may be portraits.

(A) Only conclusion II follows
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follow
(C) Both conclusion I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.12

What should come in place of '?' in the given series? 17, 32, 93, 460, 3213, ?

(A) 35332
(B) 22484
(C) 25696
(D) 28908

Q.13

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '–' and '×' are interchanged and '+' and '÷' are interchanged? 99 + 9 – 19 × 59 ÷ 29 = ?

(A) 169
(B) 189
(C) 179
(D) 153

Q.14

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the following series based on the English alphabetical order? EVD, ITH ,MRL ,QPP, ?

(A) UNS
(B) UMS
(C) UMT
(D) UNT

Q.16

In a certain code language, ‘under the impression’ is written as ‘ly ga po’ and ‘first impression matters’ is writtenas ‘ka mo po’. How will ‘impression’ be writtenin that language?

(A) ka
(B) po
(C) mo
(D) ly

Q.17

8 is related to 62 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 11 is related to 119. To which of the following is 15 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 123
(B) 223
(C) 423
(D) 323

Q.18

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: Some pigs are frogs. All bats are pigs. Conclusions: (I) At least some bats are frogs (II) All pigs are bats.

(A) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(B) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(C) Only conclusion (I) follows
(D) Only conclusion (II) follows

Q.19

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). B sits second to the right of E, who is second to the right of C. G sits third to the left of D, who is not an immediate neighbour of F. A sits second to the right of D. What is the position of E with respect to C?

(A) Immediate right
(B) Second to the left
(C) Immediate left
(D) Second to the right

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

The condition when the amount of dissolved oxygen in a water body is alarmingly decreased is called:

(A) hypoxia
(B) anoxia
(C) hypothermia
(D) acidification

Q.2

Which among the following data was used to compute the estimates in the national Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) Baseline Report?

(A) National Census data
(B) Economic Survey data
(C) National Family Health Survey (NFHS-4)
(D) Annual Employment-Unemployment Survey data

Q.3

Which of the following statements is/are true about the Iron Age? 1 The establishment of large cities took place on the basis of sizeable surplus. 2 The ceramic associated with this age was Painted Grey Ware. 3 The Indus Valley Civilization flourished during the Iron Age

(A) Only 1
(B) Only 2 and 3
(C) All 1, 2 and 3
(D) Only 1 and 2

Q.4

As per the Periodic Labour Force data 2023, which of the following states recorded the highest unemployment rate in urban areas for the age group 15 years and above?

(A) Kerala
(B) Chhattisgarh
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.6

'Running for My Life: One Lost Boy's Journey from the Killing Fields of Sudan to the Olympic Games' an autobiography depicting the struggle for life to success in life is written by who among the following personalities?

(A) Jesse Owens
(B) Lopez Lomong
(C) Noah Lyles
(D) Arnold Palmer

Q.7

The All-India Kisan Sabha was founded in Lucknow in April _____ with Swami Sahjanand Saraswati as the president.

(A) 1937
(B) 1934
(C) 1936
(D) 1935

Q.8

In badminton, how high above the ground is the net positioned at the edges?

(A) 5.1 feet
(B) 5.2 feet
(C) 5.3 feet
(D) 5.4 feet

Q.9

Kudumbashree is a poverty eradication and women empowerment programme. In which state of India does this programme operate?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Kerala
(C) Karnataka
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.10

Who among the following musicians was a member of Navratnas of Akbar?

(A) Naubat Khan
(B) Amir Khusrau
(C) Tansen
(D) Nizamuddin Auliya

Q.11

What is the specific field of study focused on examining extinct animals?

(A) Glaciology
(B) Palaeontology
(C) Gemology
(D) Economic geology

Q.12

Under which of the following Articles is Right to Equality mentioned?

(A) Articles 10–12
(B) Articles 19–22
(C) Articles 14-18
(D) Articles 1-4

Q.13
The Sun Temple at Konark, the Khajuraho Temple in Madhya Pradesh and the recently constructed Ram Temple in Ayodhya are examples of temples designed in which style of temple architecture?

(A) Nagara
(B) Dravida
(C) Hoysala
(D) Vesara

Q.14
Who among the following appoints the Acting Chief Justice in the absence of the Chief Justice of India?

(A) Senior most Judge of the Supreme Court
(B) Prime Minister
(C) President
(D) Council of Ministers

Q.15
Which Indian classical dance form has composition in Meitei language?

(A) Sattriya
(B) Chhau
(C) Manipuri
(D) Bharatanatyam

Q.16
Which of the following leaders died after being hit by sticks while protesting against the Simon Commission?

(A) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(B) Lala Lajpat Rai
(C) Bhagat Singh
(D) Chandra Shekhar Azad

Q.17
Padma Shri awardee (2023) Guru K Kalyanasundaram Pillai is an exponent of which of the following classical dance genres?

(A) Bharatnatyam
(B) Sattriya
(C) Kathak
(D) Kathakali

Q.18
In which of the following years was India the host of Women's T20 World Cup Cricket?

(A) 2016
(B) 2010
(C) 2012
(D) 2014

Q.19
In Union Budget 2023-24, an aspirational Blocks Programme covering how many blocks has been launched?

(A) 500
(B) 300
(C) 450
(D) 250

Q.20
Which of the following represents the chemical formula for sulphur hexafluoride?

(A) S_2F_6
(B) SF_6
(C) S_6F
(D) SF_2

Q.21
The founder of Bahmani kingdom who assumed the title of ‘Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah’ was _____.

(A) Hasan Gangu
(B) Feroz Shah Bahmani
(C) Muhammad Shah
(D) Ahmad Shah

Q.22

'NISHTHA' stands for _____.

(A) National Initiative for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Advancement

(B) National Inauguration for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Advancement

(C) National Inauguration for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Assessment

(D) National Initiative for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Assessment

Q.23

A famous hill station 'Ranikhet' is located on which mountain?

(A) Eastern Ghats

(B) Himalaya

(C) Western Ghats

(D) Aravali

Q.24

Which type of tea in large amount is exported from India to importing countries?

(A) Black tea

(B) Herbal tea

(C) Green tea

(D) Regular tea

Q.25

Vangpui Kut festival is organised for _____ days in Mizoram to celebrate the glory of Mizo culture and traditions.

(A) 5

(B) 4

(C) 2

(D) 3

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

Select the correct spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. The "princepal" of the college announced his early retirement today.

(A) princepil

(B) princeaple

(C) principal

(D) principel

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Overfishing and destructive fishing practices threaten the "sustainability" of marine resources and ecosystems.

(A) Reasonableness

(B) Equanimity

(C) Justifiability

(D) Indefensibility

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word in the given sentence. A "conscious" understanding of the environmental issues can bring positive changes in human life.

(A) Reflex

(B) Mechanical

(C) Beware

(D) Mindful

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. "By definition, making a pictogram" is to present and visualise data.

(A) To make a pictogram by definition

(B) In making a pictogram, the definition

(C) The purpose of a pictorgram

(D) Pictogram is making a definition

Q.6

Rectify the error in the given sentence by selecting the correct spelling from the options provided. The chord of my voilin is not tuned properly.

(A) violin
(B) wiolin
(C) voilen
(D) woilin

Q.7

Select the most appropriate degree of comparison to fill in the blank. Hunny is _____ person in his family.

(A) more taller
(B) tall
(C) taller
(D) the tallest

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. She _____ to be understood by the society.

(A) sought
(B) hunted
(C) chased
(D) looked

Q.9

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Harmony

(A) Unity
(B) Concord
(C) Accord
(D) Discord

Q.10

If someone mentions that 'the ball is in your court', what does this idiom imply?

(A) It's time for a break.
(B) It's time to play a sport.
(C) It's your turn to make a decision or take action.
(D) It's a reference to tennis.

Q.11

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. I have been / looking by my / cream sweater for / a few weeks now.

(A) cream sweater for
(B) a few weeks now
(C) looking by my
(D) I have been

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) lascivious
(B) navigate
(C) tangible
(D) rhetericol

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Rain cats and dogs

(A) Do something unplanned
(B) Raining heavily
(C) Doing something pointless
(D) Very rarely

Q.14

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. It was an interesting chat with an European gymnast that changed my mindset towards the sport.

(A) my mindset towards the sport
(B) It was an interesting
(C) an European gymnast that changed
(D) chat with

Q.15

Which of the following options is similar in meaning to the given word? Pensive

(A) Tired
(B) Troubled
(C) Thoughtful
(D) Talkative

Q.16

Select the correct option of the given sentence. Vishnu is the more courageous than all other boys in the class.

(A) Vishnu is much more courageous than all other boys in the class.
(B) Vishnu is most courageous than all other boys in the class.
(C) Vishnu is more courageous than all other boys in the class.
(D) Vishnu is the most courageous than all other boys in the class.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The speaker requested the audience to pay _____.

(A) ears
(B) silence
(C) attention
(D) activeness

Q.18

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. How long / have you / been learn / English now?

(A) How long
(B) English now
(C) been learn
(D) have you

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The council never _____ the new complex to be constructed, nor did local residents.

(A) refreshed
(B) occurred
(C) liked
(D) wanted

Q.20

Select the most appropriate form of comparative degree that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Food prices in Switzerland are “expensiver to” the rest of Western Europe.

(A) more expensive to
(B) the most expensive than
(C) more expensive than
(D) as expensiver to

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The ship struck the iceberg (1) _____ its side while it was still moving forward. In a few (2)_____, six great holes were made in the steel. Water rushed in, not in one place, but in separate places covering the Titanic hundred feet. The steel doors were therefore (3)_____ . Captain Smith soon understood that (4)_____ could save the ship. He ordered the wireless officer to send out the ship’s position and the letters CQD, which is the call for help. It told the world that the Titanic was (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) beyond
(B) under
(C) above
(D) with

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The ship struck the iceberg (1) _____ its side while it was still moving forward. In a few (2)_____, six great holes were made in the steel. Water rushed in, not in one place, but in separate places covering the Titanic hundred feet. The steel doors were therefore (3)_____ . Captain Smith soon understood that (4)_____ could save the ship. He ordered the wireless officer to send out the ship's position and the letters CQD, which is the call for help. It told the world that the Titanic was (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) weeks
(B) years
(C) moments
(D) days

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The ship struck the iceberg (1) _____ its side while it was still moving forward. In a few (2)_____, six great holes were made in the steel. Water rushed in, not in one place, but in separate places covering the Titanic hundred feet. The steel doors were therefore (3)_____ . Captain Smith soon understood that (4)_____ could save the ship. He ordered the wireless officer to send out the ship's position and the letters CQD, which is the call for help. It told the world that the Titanic was (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) useless
(B) complete
(C) painted
(D) burnt

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The ship struck the iceberg (1) _____ its side while it was still moving forward. In a few (2)_____, six great holes were made in the steel. Water rushed in, not in one place, but in separate places covering the Titanic hundred feet. The steel doors were therefore (3)_____ . Captain Smith soon understood that (4)_____ could save the ship. He ordered the wireless officer to send out the ship's position and the letters CQD, which is the call for help. It told the world that the Titanic was (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) everything
(B) all
(C) nothing
(D) enemies

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The ship struck the iceberg (1) _____ its side while it was still moving forward. In a few (2)_____, six great holes were made in the steel. Water rushed in, not in one place, but in separate places covering the Titanic hundred feet. The steel doors were therefore (3)_____ . Captain Smith soon understood that (4)_____ could save the ship. He ordered the wireless officer to send out the ship's position and the letters CQD, which is the call for help. It told the world that the Titanic was (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) victorious
(B) sinking
(C) floating
(D) reaching

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 · Answer (D) 1.35

(1.32 + 1.37 + 1.36 + 1.39 + 1.31)/5 = 6.75/5 = 1.35.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 89

With n cadets: 72n − 5 × 76 + 11 × 79 = 72.6(n + 6), so 72n + 489 = 72.6n + 435.6, 0.6n = 53.4 and n = 89.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 111.61

Selling price = 1.12 × cost, so cost = 125/1.12 = ₹111.61.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 5 years

Interest = 12,941.25 − 8,925 = ₹4,016.25. One year's interest is 8,925 × 9/100 = ₹803.25, so 4,016.25/803.25 = 5 years.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 720

SI = 3000 × 8 × 3/100 = ₹720.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 10080

LCM(12, 15, 18) = 180. 10000 ÷ 180 is about 55.6, so the least five-digit multiple is 56 × 180 = 10080.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 0.5

(1 − 1 + 0 + 2)/4 = 2/4 = 0.5.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 540

SI = 2000 × 9 × 3/100 = ₹540.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 25

Original price × 1.1 × 1.2 = 33, so the original price = 33/1.32 = ₹25.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 52.1

New total = 60 × 52 − 8 × 40 + 10 × 43 = 3120 − 320 + 430 = 3230, for 60 − 8 + 10 = 62 students: 3230/62 = 52.1.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 10

Speed of the stream = (downstream − upstream)/2 = (40 − 20)/2 = 10 km/h.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) YHAY

Each letter moves 6 places forward: I → O, R → X, G → M and D → J, L → R, E → K, C → I. So S → Y, B → H, U → A (wrapping round after Z) and S → Y: YHAY.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 1

R is the only letter in both words and 1 the only digit in both codes, so R = 1.

Q.5 · Answer (A) bq

'ball' is the only word in both sentences and 'bq' the only code in both, so ball = bq.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 48

After interchanging the signs: 16 × 4 − 18 + 14 ÷ 7 = 64 − 18 + 2 = 48.

Q.7 · Answer (D) (10, 6, 56)

The third number is five times the first plus the second: 17 × 5 + 10 = 95 and 2 × 5 + 11 = 21. Likewise 10 × 5 + 6 = 56.

Q.8 · Answer (A) C

Facing the centre, each person's right is anticlockwise. Reading to the right the order is C, G, D, E, F, B, A (B right of F, A right of B; E next to F and D; G between D and C), and the circle closes with C to the immediate right of A.

Q.9 · Answer (A) NVQM
Each letter moves 2 places forward: EMHD → GOJF and IQLH → KSNJ. So LTOK → NVQM.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Only conclusion II follows
Some portraits are flowers, so some flowers are portraits and II ('may be') follows. Nothing says every flower is a vase, so I does not follow.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 35332
Each term is the one before times the next prime, minus that prime: 17 × 2 – 2 = 32, 32 × 3 – 3 = 93, 93 × 5 – 5 = 460, 460 × 7 – 7 = 3213, and 3213 × 11 – 11 = 35332.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 179
After interchanging the signs: 99 ÷ 9 × 19 – 59 + 29 = 11 × 19 – 59 + 29 = 209 – 59 + 29 = 179.

Q.14 · Answer (D) UNT
First letters move +4 (E, I, M, Q, U), second letters –2 (V, T, R, P, N) and third letters +4 (D, H, L, P, T): UNT.

Q.16 · Answer (B) po
'impression' is the only word in both phrases and 'po' the only code in both, so impression = po.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 223
Each number is related to its square minus 2: $8^2 – 2 = 62$ and $11^2 – 2 = 119$. So $15^2 – 2 = 223$.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
The pigs that are frogs need not include any bats, so I does not follow; all bats are pigs, but not every pig need be a bat, so II does not follow.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Second to the right
'E is second to the right of C' is one of the statements. (All of them fit one arrangement: going to the right, C, D, E, A, B, G, F.)

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) hypoxia
Hypoxia is a dangerously low level of dissolved oxygen in water; anoxia is its complete absence.

Q.2 · Answer (C) National Family Health Survey (NFHS-4)
NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index Baseline Report (2021) is based on the National Family Health Survey-4 (2015-16).

Q.3 · Answer (D) Only 1 and 2
Painted Grey Ware is the pottery of the Iron Age in the Ganga plain, and that age's surplus supported the rise of large cities, so 1 and 2 are true. The Indus Valley Civilisation was a Bronze Age culture, so 3 is false.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Himachal Pradesh
SSC's key gives Himachal Pradesh as having the highest urban unemployment rate (persons aged 15 and above) of these four states in the Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Lopez Lomong
'Running for My Life' is the autobiography of Lopez Lomong, one of Sudan's 'Lost Boys', who became a US Olympic runner.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 1936
The All-India Kisan Sabha was founded at Lucknow in April 1936, with Swami Sahajanand Saraswati as its president.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 5.1 feet
A badminton net is 1.55 m (5 feet 1 inch, about 5.1 feet) high at the edges, over the doubles side lines, dipping to 1.524 m (5 feet) at the centre.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Kerala
Kudumbashree, launched by the Kerala government in 1998, is a network of women's neighbourhood groups for poverty eradication and women's empowerment.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Tansen
The singer Tansen was one of the nine gems (Navratnas) of Akbar's court. Amir Khusrau and Nizamuddin Auliya belong to the Delhi Sultanate period.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Palaeontology
Palaeontology studies the life of the past, extinct animals among it, through fossils; glaciology studies ice and gemology gemstones.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Articles 14-18
Articles 14 to 18 of the Constitution set out the Right to Equality; Articles 19 to 22 are the Right to Freedom.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Nagara
All three are built in the Nagara style of north India, with a curving shikhara over the sanctum; Konark belongs to its Kalinga (Odisha) branch.

Q.14 · Answer (C) President
Under Article 126, when the Chief Justice of India is absent or the office is vacant, the President appoints one of the other Judges of the Supreme Court as Acting Chief Justice.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Manipuri
Manipuri, the classical dance of Manipur, uses compositions in Meitei, the state's language. Sattriya is from Assam, Chhau from eastern India and Bharatanatyam from Tamil Nadu.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Lala Lajpat Rai
Lala Lajpat Rai was struck in a police lathi charge while leading a protest against the Simon Commission at Lahore in October 1928, and died of his injuries that November.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Bharatnatyam
K. Kalyanasundaram Pillai is a Bharatanatyam guru. Sattriya is a dance of Assam, Kathak of north India and Kathakali of Kerala.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 2016
India hosted the 2016 ICC Women's World Twenty20, played alongside the men's tournament.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 500
The Union Budget 2023-24 cites the Aspirational Blocks Programme, launched in January 2023, which covers 500 blocks and aims to bring essential government services to everyone in them.

Q.20 · Answer (B) SF_6
Sulphur hexafluoride has one sulphur atom and six ('hexa') fluorine atoms: SF_6.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Hasan Gangu
Hasan Gangu founded the Bahmani kingdom in the Deccan in 1347 and took the title Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah.

Q.22 · Answer (A) National Initiative for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Advancement
NISHTHA, the national training programme for school heads and teachers launched in 2019, is the National Initiative for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Advancement.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Himalaya
Ranikhet, in Almora district of Uttarakhand, is a hill station in the Kumaon Himalaya.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Black tea
Black tea (CTC and orthodox) makes up the great bulk of India's tea exports.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 2
SSC's key gives two days for the Vangpui Kut festival, held in Mizoram to celebrate Mizo culture and traditions.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) principal
The correct spelling is 'principal', the head of a college.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Indefensibility
SSC's key gives 'indefensibility', the opposite of 'sustainability' in its sense of being able to be upheld or defended (as in a sustainable argument); reasonableness and justifiability are close to that sense, and equanimity is unrelated. In this sentence the word means the ability to be kept up over time, for which none of the options is a true opposite.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Mindful
'Conscious' here means aware: 'mindful'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) The purpose of a pictorgram
'The purpose of a pictogram is to present and visualise data' says what a pictogram is for. (The option misprints 'pictogram' as 'pictorgram'.)

Q.6 · Answer (A) violin
The correct spelling is 'violin'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) the tallest
Comparing one person with everyone else in his family needs the superlative with 'the': 'Hunny is the tallest person in his family.'

Q.8 · Answer (A) sought
To 'seek' (past 'sought') to do something is to try to do it: she tried to be understood.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Discord
'Harmony' is agreement; its opposite is 'discord'. Unity, concord and accord are near-synonyms.

Q.10 · Answer (C) It's your turn to make a decision or take action.
'The ball is in your court' means it is now your turn to decide or act.

Q.11 · Answer (C) looking by my
One looks 'for' something one has lost: 'I have been looking for my cream sweater for a few weeks now.'

Q.12 · Answer (D) rhetericol
The correct spelling is 'rhetorical'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Raining heavily
To 'rain cats and dogs' is to rain very heavily.

Q.14 · Answer (C) an European gymnast that changed
'European' begins with a 'yoo' sound, a consonant sound, so it takes 'a': 'a European gymnast'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Thoughtful
'Pensive' means deep in thought: 'thoughtful'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Vishnu is more courageous than all other boys in the class.
A comparative followed by 'than' takes no 'the': 'Vishnu is more courageous than all other boys in the class.'

Q.17 · Answer (C) attention
The fixed expression is to 'pay attention'.

Q.18 · Answer (C) been learn
The present perfect continuous needs the -ing form: 'How long have you been learning English now?'

Q.19 · Answer (D) wanted
The council did not want the complex built, and neither did the residents: 'never wanted the new complex to be constructed'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) more expensive than
The comparative of 'expensive' is 'more expensive', and a comparison takes 'than': 'more expensive than the rest of Western Europe'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) with
The ship struck the iceberg 'with' its side: the side was what hit it.

Q.22 · Answer (C) moments
'In a few moments' fits the speed of the damage, done while the ship was still moving.

Q.23 · Answer (A) useless
With water rushing in at many separate places, the steel doors were 'useless'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) nothing
Captain Smith understood that 'nothing' could save the ship, so he called for help.

Q.25 · Answer (B) sinking
The CQD call for help told the world that the Titanic was 'sinking'.

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